

How do you know it's time to upgrade your printer? When you can visually compare older printouts with newer ones and see that they are not of the same quality, colour- or clarity-wise, it may be time to upgrade. Also, if the printer has undergone repairs and pops up a problem every now and then, think of upgrading.

It also depends on how and what for you use your printer. If you only occasionally use a printer for printing résumés or recipes off the Internet, you can certainly make do without an upgrade. Inkjet printers definitely score over dot-matrix ones if you are using it in a home. Text quality, for one, is much better, and you can also use an inkjet printer for other purposes such as printing on T-shirts (more on T-shirt printing in the April 2003 issue of *Digit*) and making CD labels, which are simply not possible on a dot matrix printer. On the other hand, a dot-matrix printer is the device of choice if you have a departmental store or a similar business where volume printing is the norm.

If you would also like to do a bit of scanning (digitising your old photographs, for instance), you could consider an entry-level Multi-Function Device (MFD). It can scan, print and copy. Not only does this save money in terms of the purchase cost, the

Laser printers are used where high volume of printing is needed

